

Signals from The Deep: The Earth's Call



Figure 1: Strike of an earthquake (Shutterstock, 2020)

The rhythm of ordinary days continues, trusting that the earth beneath our feet is solid, stable, secure and dependable. But when we start to think what actually happens in the deep underneath, we come across that our world is restlessly moving. Below the surface of our mother earth there are many tectonic plates which are always in a constant motion and building gradual tension, waiting for a moment to break free. Lately the heartbeat of earth seems to be more quickening. In recent few days, some horrifying warnings have emerged that a high magnitude earth quack could strike the south Asian region, with Bangladesh on the standing openly in the path, making people frightened and anxious at their very core. [1]

Almost everyone knows that “The Mighty Earthquake” is a natural disaster and we don’t know when, where and how they may bestow upon with immense power. But with the blessings of modern technology, scientists can now sometimes anticipate the signs of a severe earthquake. Our motherland, Bangladesh has always been a center of attention for the earthquake prediction studies because our country sits upon 3 big tectonic intersections on earth. The continuous collisions of them gradually build up unthinkable pressure on the ground. Though small quakes shake us time to time, they do not contain the accumulated pressure. So the real pressure remains waiting and building stronger for its hour.

A mega earthquake, (approximately magnitude of 7-9) no need to be said, one of the most powerful events the people can even think of. It is impossible to think of what unimaginable circumstances Bangladesh, specially the Dhaka city, will have to face if this actually happens as the capital has the largest number of population with infrastructure at its disadvantage. There are countless buildings in cities and villages that have no strength against violent shaking; there are very few earthquake-resistant buildings and nearly all standing close together. The narrow roads, unplanned population growth are a great concerning matter. 2023 Turkey-Syria earthquake is a great reminder to human of histories one of the powerful mega quakes with millions of people suffering from it.

The protection barriers of Bangladesh are not very much secured for the aftermath circumstances. Though the fire and civil service heroes are motivated to offer their best in the devastating crisis moment, their equipment and operational capacity remain far from adequate for something like a mega quake. [3]



Figure 2: Destruction of Turkey-Syria earthquake

Yet there remains some hope. Scientists are using modern science like sensor machine, AI tools and satellite mapping methods to detect the shifting of the crusts: so the signals from these can be a very important signs. With the prepared and strengthened system, the people of our country can be guided awareness through timely warnings and swift evacuation.

References

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